



BASIC ELEMENTS OF INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR IN ORGANIZATIONS

Chapter 9
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BASIC ELEMENTS OF HUMAN BEHAVIOR

- **Personality:** The relatively permanent set of psychological and behavioral attributes that distinguish one person from another
- **behaviors:** the way a person acts or conducts themselves, especially toward others
 - **Learning:** A relatively permanent change in behavior based on experience or training.
 - **Motivation:** The set of forces that cause people to behave in certain ways
- **attitudes:** Complexes of beliefs and feelings that people have about specific ideas, situations, or other people
- **attribution:** The process of observing behavior and attributing causes to it
- **perception:** The set of processes by which an individual becomes aware of and interprets information about the environment

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- **“Big Five” personality traits:** A popular **personality framework** based on five key traits
 - **agreeableness:** A person's **ability to get along with others**
 - **conscientiousness:** The **number of things** a person can **effectively work on** at one time
 - **neuroticism:** **Extent** to which a person is **poised, calm, resilient, and secure**
 - **extraversion:** A person's **comfort level with relationships**
 - **openness:** A person's **rigidity of beliefs** and **range of interests**

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- “Big Five” personality traits:
 - agreeableness:
 - Person is gentle, cooperative, forgiving, understanding, and good-natured in their dealings with others
 - does not mean that an individual automatically “agrees” with everything --- individual is cordial and more pleasant than someone who is less agreeable
 - agreeable people will be better able to develop good working relationships with coworkers, subordinates, and higher-level managers
 - might also extend to relationships with customers, suppliers, and other key organizational constituents

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- “Big Five” personality traits:
 - **conscientiousness:**
 - ability to effectively multitask
 - People who focus on relatively fewer tasks and projects are likely to be organized, systematic, careful, thorough, responsible, and self-disciplined as they work to complete those tasks and projects.
 - Others tend to take on too many tasks and projects and/or to procrastinate and, as a result, are more disorganized, careless, and irresponsible
 - Research has found that more conscientious people tend to be higher performers

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- “Big Five” personality traits:
 - **Neuroticism.**
 - People who are **less neurotic** will be relatively **poised, calm, resilient, and secure.**
 - But people who are **more neurotic** will be **more excitable, insecure, reactive, and subject to extreme mood swings.**
 - People with **less neuroticism** might be expected to better handle job stress, pressure, and tension.
 - Their **stability** might also lead them to be seen as more reliable than their less-stable counterparts.

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- “Big Five” personality traits:

- **Extraversion**

- person's comfort level with relationships.
 - People who are called “extraverts” are sociable, talkative, assertive, and open to establishing new relationships.
 - Introverts are much less sociable, talkative, assertive, and less open to establishing new relationships.
 - Research suggests that extraverts generally tend to be higher overall job performers than introverts and that they are also more likely to be attracted to jobs based on personal relationships, such as sales and marketing positions.

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- “Big Five” personality traits:

- **Openness**

- person's rigidity of beliefs and range of interests.
 - they are willing to listen to new ideas and to change their own ideas, beliefs, and attitudes as a result of new information.
 - They also tend to have broad interests and to be curious, imaginative, and creative.
 - They are expected to be better performers, owing to their flexibility and the likelihood that they will be better accepted by others in the organization.
 - On the other hand, people with low levels of openness are less receptive to new ideas and less willing to change their minds.
 - People with openness are receptive to change whereas others resist the change

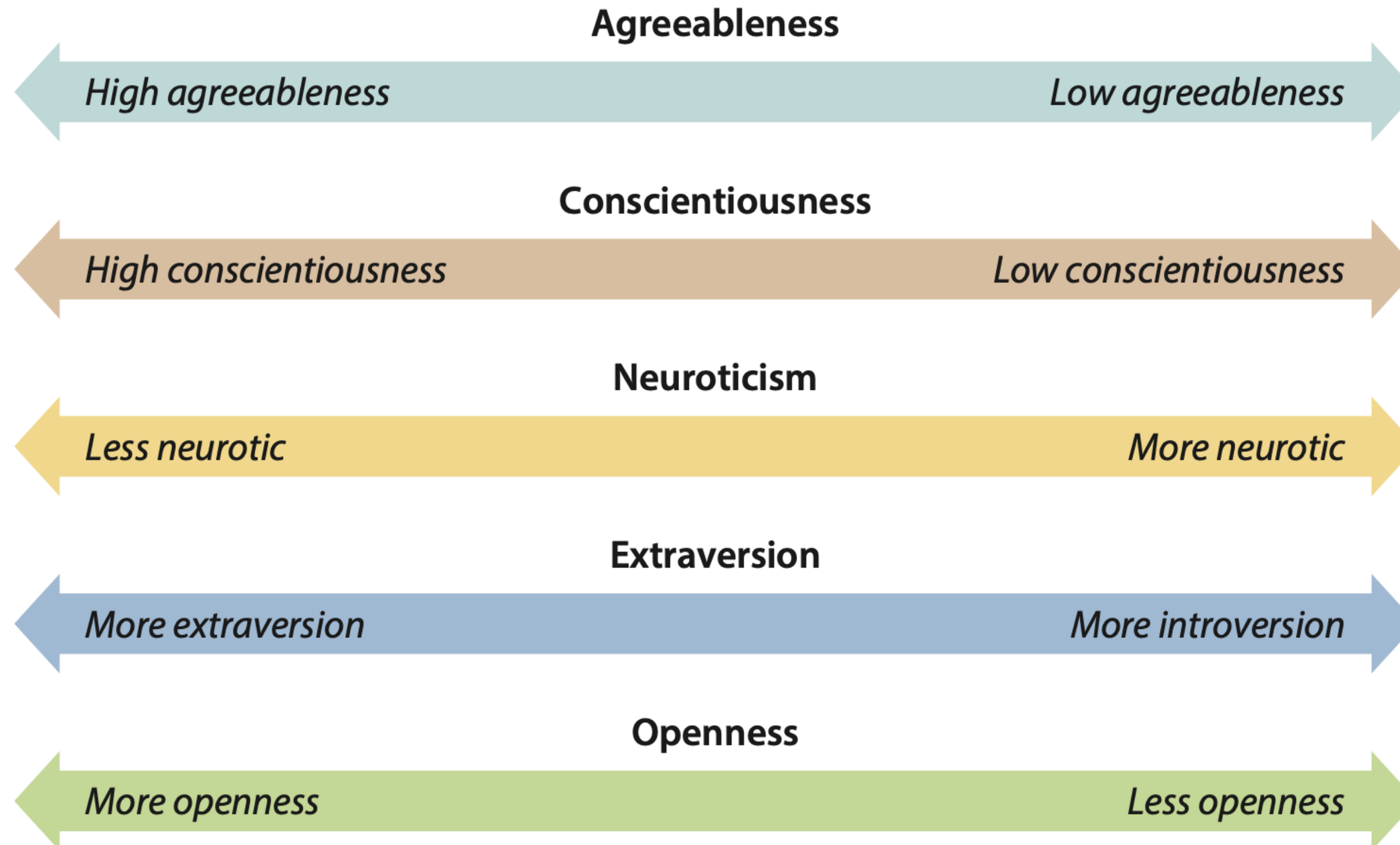
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PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR



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- **The Myers-Briggs Framework**

- **Extraversion (E) versus Introversion (I).** Extraverts get their energy from being around other people, whereas introverts are worn out by others and need solitude to recharge their energy.
- **Sensing (S) versus Intuition (N).** The sensing type prefers concrete/factual things (instructions), whereas intuitives prefer abstract concepts (imagination/innovation)
- **Thinking (T) versus Feeling (F).** Thinking individuals base their decisions more on logic and reason, whereas feeling individuals base their decisions more on feelings and emotions.
- **Judging (J) versus Perceiving (P).** People who are the judging type enjoy completion or being finished, whereas perceiving types enjoy the process and open-ended situations.

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- **Other Personality Traits at Work**

- **locus of control:** The degree to which a person believes that his or her behavior has a direct impact on the consequences of that behavior
 - **internal locus of control:** people who believe that individuals are in control of their lives
 - **External locus of control:** Other people think that fate, chance, luck, or other people's behavior determines what happens to them
- **self-efficacy:** An individual's beliefs about her or his capabilities to perform a task
- **authoritarianism:** The extent to which a person believes that power and status differences are appropriate within hierarchical social systems like organizations

PERSONALITY AND INDIVIDUAL BEHAVIOR

- **Machiavellianism:** Behavior directed at gaining power and controlling the behavior of others
- **self-esteem:** The extent to which a person believes that he or she is a worthwhile and deserving individual
- **risk propensity:** The degree to which an individual is willing to take chances and make risky decision

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EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Emotional intelligence, or EQ**, refers to the extent to which people are self-aware, manage their emotions, motivate themselves, express empathy for others, and possess social skills.
 - **Self-Awareness**. a person's capacity for being aware of how they are feeling. More self-awareness allows people to more effectively guide their own lives and behaviors.
 - **Managing Emotions**: person's capacities to balance anxiety, fear, and anger so that they do not overly interfere with getting things accomplished.
 - **Motivating Oneself**: This dimension refers to a person's ability to remain optimistic and to continue striving in the face of setbacks, barriers, and failure.
 - **Empathy**: Empathy refers to a person's ability to understand how others are feeling, even without being explicitly told.

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

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- **Social Skill.** This refers to a person's ability to get along with others and to establish positive relationships.
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- Preliminary research suggests that people with high EQ may perform better than others, especially in jobs that require a high degree of interpersonal interaction and that involve influencing or directing the work of others. Moreover, EQ appears to be something that is not biologically based but can be developed.



**QUESTIONS
PLEASE!**

